

Week 4 Search Workbook

CFAN 3091V | Database Search and Pearl Growing

Name: _____ Current date: _____

Keep this workbook. It becomes the first draft of the Week 5 Search Record.

Monday 1. Question to Concepts

Current research question or focused problem:

Underline the parts a database could index. Use only the concepts your question needs.

Harvest alternate terms from a paper you already have: title, abstract nouns, author keywords, database subject headings, and the introduction's framing sentences. Add a term to a row whenever a good record shows you one.

Concept 1: _____

Alternate terms used in another field, place, or period:

Concept 2: _____

Alternate terms:

Concept 3: _____

Alternate terms:

Concept 4, if needed: _____

Alternate terms:

Draft query: Connect alternatives within a concept with **OR**; connect different concepts with **AND**. Record the syntax you actually use.

Starting database or disciplinary collection: _____

Why its coverage fits this question:

Monday 2. Query Decision Log

Attempt 1

Database and date: _____

Exact query and filters:

Result count: _____ **What fit or failed:**

Next change and reason:

Attempt 2

Database and date: _____

Exact query and filters:

Result count: _____ **What fit or failed:**

Next change and reason:

Attempt 3, if needed

Database and date: _____

Exact query and filters:

Result count: _____ **What fit or failed:**

Next change and reason:

Monday 3. Source Role and Fit

A keep decision must name the job the source can do. An exclude decision must name the mismatch.

Source A

Short citation or Zotero key: _____

Role: ☐ primary study ☐ review ☐ methods ☐ policy or technical report ☐ dataset ☐ other

Which part of the question does it address?

What do its evidence, context, or date allow it to support?

Decision: ☐ keep for _____ ☐ exclude because _____

Source B

Short citation or Zotero key: _____

Role: ☐ primary study ☐ review ☐ methods ☐ policy or technical report ☐ dataset ☐ other

Which part of the question does it address?

What do its evidence, context, or date allow it to support?

Decision: ☐ keep for _____ ☐ exclude because _____

Monday 4. Zotero Setup Check

☐ Thesis collection created

☐ Item page captured rather than an isolated PDF when possible

☐ Item type, title, authors, date, venue, pages, and DOI checked

☐ Discovery-path and source-role tags applied consistently

☐ One note created with contribution, connection, and limits headings

Metadata correction made today:

One query worth keeping even though it failed:

Wednesday 1. Reading Clinic and Pearl

For two framing sentences in the Week 1 article, record which citation does the work and what job it performs.

Sentence or claim 1:

Source cited and job: define, establish, complicate, or justify:

Sentence or claim 2:

Source cited and job:

Choose the Pearl

Pearl citation:

Why it is close enough to orient the focused problem:

If this is not a 2020-or-later review, document what you tried and why this source is the better starting point:

Wednesday 2. Trace Backward

Select five cited sources that bear on the focused problem. Repeated citation is a clue, not an inclusion rule.

1. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

2. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

3. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

4. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

5. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

Wednesday 3. Trace Forward

Cited-by tool used: ☐ Web of Science ☐ Scopus ☐ Google Scholar ☐ other: _____

1. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

2. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

3. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

4. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

5. Short citation: _____

Why it belongs: _____

Wednesday 4. Capture and Verify

For the pearl and 10 traced sources:

☐ Applied **pearl**, **backward**, or **forward** discovery-path tags

☐ Checked item type, title, authors, date, venue, pages, and DOI

☐ Corrected incomplete or inaccurate metadata

One metadata problem found and repaired:

One branch that produced no useful source, if applicable:

Wednesday 5. Three Structured Notes

Complete the full notes in Zotero. Record the compact version here.

Pearl Source

Main contribution: _____

Connection to my question: _____

Limits or unresolved questions: _____

Backward Source

Main contribution: _____

Connection to my question: _____

Limits or unresolved questions: _____

Forward Source

Main contribution: _____

Connection to my question: _____

Limits or unresolved questions: _____

Wednesday 6. Partner Reconstruction Audit

Partner name: _____

One inclusion reason the partner could reconstruct:

One reason that was unclear, and how I revised it:

Week 5 Handoff

Most useful search decision from this workbook:

Next search action and date:
